

Word family: **friend / friends / friendly / friendship / friendliness / befriend / unfriendly**

Base word: friend

Plural: friends

Related forms: friendly, friendship, friendliness, befriend, unfriendly

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / adjective-related forms (相關形容詞) / verb-related form (相關動詞)

Your sentence:

> “My favourite childhood **friend** was a boy called Ryan...”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **friend** means a **person you know well, like, trust, and have a personal relationship with**.

Ryan was not simply someone the speaker knew. He was someone with whom the speaker had a close personal bond during childhood.

繁體中文： **與自己彼此熟悉、互相信任和喜歡，並保持私人感情關係的人；朋友**

中文翻譯：

> “My favourite childhood **friend** was a boy called Ryan...”

「我最喜歡的一位童年**朋友**，是一個叫 Ryan 的男孩子.....」

Here:

friend = 與自己有私人感情、信任和長期相處關係的人

1. **friend = person you know and like personally (人物關係) — 朋友**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: A person whom you know well and have a relationship of affection, trust, or mutual liking with.

Practice 1 — Original

> “My favourite childhood **friend** was a boy called Ryan.”

「我最喜歡的一位童年**朋友**，是一個叫 Ryan 的男孩子。」

Practice 2

> “She has been my close **friend** since university.”

「她從大學時代開始就是我的好**朋友**。」

Practice 3

> “Good **friends** support each other during difficult times.”

「好**朋友**會在困難的時候互相支持。」

****friend** = 與自己彼此熟悉、喜歡和信任，而且具有私人感情關係的人**

Common:

- * close friend
- * childhood friend
- * old friend
- * best friend
- * family friend

These remain one core interpersonal sense.

2. ****friend** = person who supports a person/cause/group (支持者) — 支持者；友好人士**

****Friend**** can also mean someone who supports, helps, or is sympathetic toward a particular person, group, institution, or cause.

Practice 4

> “She has always been a **friend of** the arts.”

「她一直都是藝術界的**支持者**。」

Practice 5

> “The organization has many **friends and supporters** in the community.”

「這個機構在社區內有很多**友好人士和支持者**。」

****friend of + cause/group** = 對某個群體、理念或事業抱有支持、友善或協助態度的人**

This is genuinely different from a personal friendship.

A person may be:

> **a friend of the museum**

without personally knowing the museum staff.

So the mental concept is:

> **support/allegiance**

rather than:

> **personal relationship**

3. **friend** = ally / person on your side (盟友 / 自己人) — 盟友 ; 友方

In conflict, competition, politics, or strategic contexts, **friend** can mean someone who is on your side rather than opposing you.

Practice 6

> “At a time like this, it is important to know who your **friends** are.”

「在這種時候，知道誰是你的**盟友 / 支持你的人**很重要。」

Practice 7

> “The country traditionally regarded its neighbour as a **friend** rather than an enemy.”

「該國傳統上把鄰國視為**友邦 / 盟友**，而不是敵人。」

friend = 在衝突、競爭或利益關係中支持自己、站在自己一方的人或團體

This overlaps with Meaning 2, but the **ally vs opponent** contrast is strong enough to make it useful as a separate learner sense.

4. **friend** = contact on a social-media platform (社交媒體) — 好友 ; 網上聯絡人

In social-media and online-platform contexts, **friend** can mean a person connected to your account through the platform's “friend” system.

Practice 8

> “I have hundreds of **friends** on the platform.”

「我在這個平台上有數百名**好友 / 網上聯絡人**。」

Practice 9

> “She added me as a **friend** after the event.”

「活動結束後，她把我加為平台上的**好友**。」

friend = 在社交平台上與自己的帳戶建立正式連結的使用者，不一定代表現實生活中關係親密**

This is an important modern meaning because:

> **online friend ≠ necessarily close personal friend**

The platform relationship can be much weaker than ordinary friendship.

5. **friend** = familiar form of address (稱呼) — 朋友；老兄**

In some contexts, **friend** is used when directly addressing someone.

Practice 10

> “Listen, my **friend**, you need to be more careful.”

「聽着，**朋友 / 老兄**，你要小心一點。」

Practice 11

> “What can I do for you, **friend**?”

「**朋友**，我可以怎樣幫你？」

friend = 用作直接稱呼別人的詞語，不一定表示雙方真的具有私人友誼**

The tone can be:

- * genuinely warm,
- * humorous,
- * formal,

* or even confrontational depending on context.

So this deserves explicit treatment.

Related form: **friendly**

Friendly has several useful branches.

**friendly = kind and pleasant toward others (友善的) **

Practice 12

> “The staff were very **friendly**.”

「員工非常**友善**。」

Practice 13

> “He gave me a **friendly** smile.”

「他給了我一個**友善的微笑**。」

friendly = 對別人表現親切、和善和容易相處的態度

**friendly = not hostile (友好的) **

Practice 14

> “The two countries maintain **friendly relations**.”

「兩國維持**友好關係**。」

Practice 15

> “The discussion remained **friendly** despite their disagreement.”

「雖然彼此有不同意見，討論仍保持**友好、不帶敵意**。」

friendly = 沒有敵意或對抗，彼此關係和善的

This is closely related to the adjective's social warmth sense, but broader than personal friendliness.

**friendly = sports match not part of official competition (友誼賽) **

Practice 16

> “The teams played a **friendly** before the season began.”

「兩支球隊在賽季開始前踢了一場**友誼賽**。」

Practice 17

> “It was only a **friendly**, so the result did not affect the league table.”

「那只是一場**友誼賽**，所以結果不影響聯賽排名。」

a friendly = 不屬於正式競賽排名、主要用作練習或交流的體育比賽

This is a distinct noun use of **friendly**.

Related form: **friendship**

Friendship means the relationship or bond between friends.

Practice 18

> “Their **friendship** lasted for many years.”

「他們的**友誼**維持了很多年。」

Practice 19

> “Trust is important in any **friendship**.”

「任何**友誼 / 朋友關係**都需要信任。」

friendship = 朋友之間建立的感情、信任、關係和互相支持

This is directly relevant to your passage.

Related form: **friendliness**

****Friendliness**** means the quality of being friendly.

Practice 20

> “Her ****friendliness**** made everyone feel welcome.”

「她的****友善態度****令所有人都感到受歡迎。」

Practice 21

> “Visitors often comment on the ****friendliness**** of the staff.”

「訪客經常稱讚員工的****友善****。」

****friendliness = 對別人親切、和善和願意友好相處的特質****

Related form: ****befriend****

****Befriend**** means to become someone's friend or deliberately act in a friendly way toward them.

Practice 22

> “She quickly ****befriended**** the new student.”

「她很快便跟新同學****成為朋友 / 主動友善地接近對方****。」

Practice 23

> “He ****befriended**** several people in the neighbourhood.”

「他跟社區裡幾個人****建立了朋友關係****。」

****befriend someone = 主動與某人建立友好關係並成為朋友****

This is a useful verb-family extension.

Related form: ****unfriendly****

****Unfriendly**** means not friendly, warm, or welcoming.

Practice 24

> “The receptionist seemed rather **unfriendly**.”

「接待員看起來相當**不友善 / 冷淡**。」

Practice 25

> “His tone sounded **unfriendly**.”

「他的語氣聽起來**不太友善**。」

unfriendly = 對人冷淡、不親切或帶有不友好態度的

Important distinction: **friend vs acquaintance**

This is one of the most important learner contrasts.

friend

= someone you have a personal bond with

acquaintance

= someone you know, but not closely

> “He’s a friend.”

= 他是我的朋友。

> “He’s only an acquaintance.”

= 他只是我認識的人 / 泛泛之交。

So:

knowing someone ≠ automatically being friends

Important distinction: **friend vs classmate**

Especially relevant to your passage.

classmate

= someone in the same class

friend

= someone with whom you have a personal relationship

Ryan began as the speaker's:

> **classmate**

and then became his:

> **friend**

A classmate does not automatically become a friend.

Important distinction: **friend vs colleague**

friend

describes a personal relationship.

colleague

describes a work relationship.

A colleague may also become a friend, but the words identify different relationships.

Important distinction: **friend vs ally**

friend

usually suggests personal affection or friendliness.

ally

focuses more specifically on cooperation and being on the same side.

In strategic contexts, **friend** can approach the meaning of **ally**, but ordinary friendship is broader emotionally.

Important distinction: **friendly vs friend**

A person can be:

> **friendly**

without being:

> **your friend**

For example, a shop assistant may be very friendly, but you do not necessarily have a personal friendship.

So:

friendly = describes behaviour/attitude

friend = describes a relationship/person

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

- * **friend**
- * **friends**
- * **friendly**
- * **friendship**
- * **friendliness**
- * **befriend**
- * **unfriendly**

Useful expressions and compounds include:

- * close friend
- * childhood friend
- * best friend
- * family friend
- * friend of + cause/group
- * social-media friend
- * friendly match
- * befriend someone

The Golden Manual requires common derivational forms, negative forms, person/relationship nouns, and useful modern domain extensions to be included when they add real learning value.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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friend — personal relationship	與自己彼此熟悉、喜歡和信任，而且具有私人感情關係的人
friend — supporter	對某個人、團體、機構、理念或事業抱有支持和友善態度的人
friend — ally	在衝突、競爭或利益關係中支持自己、站在自己一方的人或團體
friend — social media	在社交平台上與自己帳戶建立正式連結的使用者，不一定代表現實中關係親密
friend — form of address	用來直接稱呼別人的詞語，不一定表示雙方真的具有私人友誼
friendly	對別人親切、和善、不帶敵意的
a friendly — sports	不屬於正式競賽排名、主要用作練習或交流的友誼賽
friendship	朋友之間建立的感情、信任、關係和互相支持
befriend	主動與某人建立友好關係並成為朋友
unfriendly	對人冷淡、不親切或帶有不友好態度的

For your original sentence

> “My favourite childhood **friend** was a boy called Ryan...”

The exact meaning is:

friend = 與自己彼此熟悉、喜歡、信任並有私人感情關係的人

More specifically:

childhood friend = 在童年時期建立並維持朋友關係的人

So:

> **my favourite childhood friend**

= **我童年時最喜歡、關係很親近的一位朋友**

For your database, I would count **5 genuinely useful core meanings** for **friend**:

1. **personal friend — someone you know, like, and trust**

2. **supporter of a person, group, institution, or cause**
3. **ally / someone on your side**
4. **social-media friend / platform contact**
5. **friend as a form of address**

I would keep **friendly, friendship, friendliness, befriend,** and **unfriendly** as family extensions rather than increase the core **friend** count.